

Comprehensive Leave Policy

Entitlement, Accrual Schedules, Carry-Forward Rules & Mid-Year Joining Provisions

1. Annual & Paid Time Off (PTO)

All regular full-time team members receive a baseline annual entitlement of 20 working days. Leaves accrue proportionately at a rate of 1.66 days per completed calendar month. Employees may take annual leave in increments of half days or full days subject to line manager pre-approval.

2. Sick & Medical Leave

Employees are granted 10 paid sick leave days per calendar year for illness, medical appointments, or recovery. For absences exceeding 3 consecutive working days, an official medical certificate signed by a licensed medical practitioner is required upon return to work.

3. Carry-Forward & Expiry Terms

Leave Category	Max Annual Carry-Over	Expiry Window	Encashment Policy
Annual Leave (PTO)	Up to 5 Days	Must use by March 31	Non-encashable
Sick & Medical	0 Days (Lapsed)	Expires Dec 31 annually	Non-encashable
Compensatory Off	Up to 3 Days	60 days from occurrence	Forfeited if unused

4. Provisions for Employees Joining After July 1st

- Pro-Rata Annual Accrual:** Employees joining after July 1st receive pro-rated PTO calculated on remaining full months (e.g., joining August 1st yields 8.3 accrued days for the year).
- Probationary Access:** During the initial 90-day probationary window, new hires may only draw accrued sick leave or up to 2 advance days of PTO with VP/Director sign-off.
- Carry-Over Exemption:** Employees joining in Q4 (October through December) may carry forward up to 100% of their accrued, unused leave into the following calendar year without early March expiration.

Important Administrative Rule

All leave requests spanning five consecutive business days or longer must be submitted to the HR Portal at least 14 days in advance to enable planned work redistribution.